

Replace Negative Voices with Positive Voices

Of course, once you take responsibility for where you are and set your sights on something better, the world will try to knock you off course. I'm not talking about losing a job or going through a personal tragedy. I'm talking about a friend trying to crush your dreams by making a sarcastic comment about how "people like us" can't become wealthy. You know what I'm talking about. It's like a buddy finding out you're on a diet and immediately offering you a slice of cake. Even if you don't talk openly about your financial goals, you'll be bombarded with messages about how wealth is exclusive and how people like you can't get there. You'll hear all the myths about millionaires that we've already debunked. These things will get stuck in your brain, playing over and over again as you try to make progress. Here's my advice for when those messages play on a loop in your mind: change the tape. Whatever track plays long enough and loud enough in your mind will start to sound like the truth. You can take control of your thoughts and replace false messages with the truth of what we're discovering about millionaires—and the truth that you can become one, too.

In the previous chapter, I shared the wisdom in Earl Nightingale's message *The Strangest Secret*. He taught that we become what we think about, that we are always planting seeds of belief (or doubt) in our minds. If that's true, then we not only need to remove the junk from our brains that's getting in our way, but we also need to replace those false messages with encouragement and truth. For that, you need to be intentional about having a team of positive thinkers in your life.

Our research has shown that we all need to build a network of encouraging, like-minded, and challenging people to support us on our millionaire journey. While almost all the millionaires we studied are self-made, they aren't completely isolated. They are, however, careful about who they allow to speak into their lives. In fact, 98% of them say they actively integrate feedback from other people. Despite their success, they